

County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Monday, September 15th, Session #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PSktp_tWJ1A
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Report: Budget Hearings & County Council Session

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Note: This session operates as an ongoing continuation of budget hearings following a recess. -

Session Type & Topic: Budget Hearings and Revenue Review [00:00:25](#) - **Summary of**

Discussion: - The council reviewed local income tax (LIT) funds, confirming cash balances and estimated revenues for departments including the sheriff, prosecutor, jail, and county council. - Total LIT cash balance was confirmed at \$3,318,784, with estimated 2026 revenue sitting at \$2,621,049. - Consensus was reached to maintain LIT budgets without trimming, anticipating supplemental amounts and recognizing that budgeted LIT funds are not always fully expended. - Staff presented health insurance additions for county council positions (\$18,681.81 for health insurance, plus vision and dental lines), bringing the updated line total to \$185,083. - Discussion regarding ARP interest, operating balances (targeting a \$6 million reduction/operating balance), lines of credit, and departmental givebacks.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Reconvened from recess [00:00:27](#) for municipal budget hearings by the presiding officer.
 - **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Council members (including identified speakers Mark, Eugene, Bill, Jim, Dan, Jessica, Brad).
 - *Staff Present:* Whitney, Elizabeth, Tanya, Rick, Matt, and department representatives.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Mark (implied by meeting facilitation).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** None recorded.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:09:42](#) **County Council General Budget Adjustments & Operating Balances**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council leadership and staff (Whitney/Elizabeth/Matt).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive review of county general fund deficits, proposed cuts, and operating balance targets. The council debated setting the operating balance at \$6 million (a \$500,000 reduction from prior projections) to balance short-term fixes against long-term fiscal challenges. Staff presented reconciled shortfall figures and adjustments.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Consensus reached to target a \$6 million operating balance and incorporate finalized revenue and health insurance updates. Approved by Voice Vote.
 - [01:19:40](#) **Final Budget Reconciliation & Departmental Givebacks**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth and Matt.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Elizabeth presented updated revenue figures for 2025 (\$2,018,630 on Form 2) and gateway calculations resulting in an operating balance of \$4,441,542 before adjustments. After factoring in health insurance savings (\$850,000), givebacks (\$237,810), overage buffers (\$250,000), and interest (\$300,000), the calculated difference resulted in a balanced adjustment of \$39,352. The council also explored potential salary adjustments for EMS and 911 communication personnel using vacancy givebacks or overtime savings.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Board accepted updated financial metrics and agreed to coordinate further review ahead of the formal adoption meeting. Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general floor comments from members of the general public were recorded during this budget work session.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - A finance meeting is scheduled for Thursday at 11:30 AM, followed by a reconvened budget hearing recess at 12:00 PM (noon).
 - Department heads (Sheriff, Prosecutor, 911, EMS) agreed to review vacancy and overtime accounts to report back on potential salary funding lines prior to Thursday.
 - The statutory budget adoption meeting is officially set for September 23rd.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was placed into ongoing recess / adjourned by voice consensus following closing remarks at [01:35:56](#).
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